

BEYOND THE CREASE

From a broke backpacker staring at the gates of Galeries Lafayette in Paris to reskinning its historic Mumbai flagship, it's a full circle moment for Ankon Mitra

By **RIDHI KALE**

Photograph by HARDIK CHHABRA

In 2008, Ankon Mitra was a design student on a shoestring budget, trekking from London to Paris. Standing before the Haussmann-style grandeur of the Galeries Lafayette flagship, he felt like a ghost in the machine. "I felt completely out of place," Mitra recalls. "I half-expected the staff to tell me I didn't belong. My entire trip probably cost less than a single item in that store." Fast forward to today, and the intimidation has turned into an invitation. In a definitive "full circle" moment, Mitra was commissioned to design the visual identity for the brand's entry into India, housed in the heritage Turner Morrison and Voltas House buildings, near Elphinstone Circle in Mumbai. He isn't just a visitor anymore; he is the visionary tasked with "reskinning" an icon.